

Calendar
9/25/2024

TWENTY-FOURTH NORTHERN MARIANAS COMMONWEALTH

LEGISLATURE

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

September 25, 2024

Fourth Reg. Session, 2026

H. J. R. 24-22

A HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION

To approve the Mayor of Saipan's request to reinstate and fill essential, vacant personnel positions within the Office of the Mayor, Municipality of Saipan, pursuant to Public Law 24-20.

1 **WHEREAS,** the Twenty-Fourth Northern Marianas Commonwealth
2 Legislature enacted Public Law 24-20, also known as the Revised Appropriations
3 and Budget Authority Act of 2026; and

4 **WHEREAS,** Public Law 24-20 establishes strict hiring restrictions and
5 personnel cost containment measures for the government of the Commonwealth of
6 the Northern Mariana Islands (CNMI); and

7 **WHEREAS,** Section 609 of Public Law 24-20 explicitly states that any
8 position that becomes vacant shall be closed out, and that unused funds for such
9 position shall go to operation expenses within that department or agency within 30
10 days upon vacancy unless a request is made to the Legislature for reinstatement of
11 the vacant position, which shall be approved by a joint resolution; and

12 **WHEREAS,** through MISC. COMM. (House) 24-129, the Mayor of
13 Saipan issued an urgent appeal to immediately reinstate and fill critical operational

1 vacancies within the Office of the Mayor, warning that these prolonged shortages
2 directly compromise the delivery of essential public services; and

3 **WHEREAS**, the Mayor stated in his letter, “These positions are
4 foundational to the delivery of essential municipal services, public safety functions,
5 and community support programs. Prolonged vacancies have placed significant
6 operational strain on the Mayor’s Office, directly affecting our ability to maintain
7 municipal facilities, respond to community concerns, manage field operations,
8 support public safety initiatives, and administer critical programs. Without the
9 ability to fill these essential positions, the municipality’s capacity to meet statutory
10 obligations and provide timely, reliable services to our residents is substantially
11 diminished.”; and

12 **WHEREAS**, the Legislature finds that maintaining full operational
13 capacity within the municipal government is vital to the public health, safety, and
14 well-being of the residents of Saipan; and

15 **WHEREAS**, filling these specific positions are in the best interest of the
16 Commonwealth and qualifies as an essential operational need under the intent of
17 the law;

18 **NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED**, by the House of
19 Representatives of the Twenty-Fourth Northern Marianas Commonwealth
20 Legislature, the Senate concurring, that the Legislature hereby approves the
21 Mayor’s request to reinstate and fill the vacant and critical positions within the

1 Office of the Mayor of Saipan pursuant to Public Law 24-20 and that the following
2 five positions are essential for the delivery of public service:

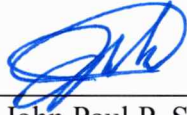
- 3 1 General Maintenance Worker
4 1 Field Operations Supervisor
5 1 Community Worker
6 1 Dog Control Program Manager
7 1 Program Management Specialist

8 **BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED**, that the Speaker of the House of
9 Representatives and the President of the Senate shall certify and the House Clerk
10 and the Senate Legislative Secretary shall attest to the adoption of this joint
11 resolution and thereafter the House Clerk shall transmit a copy to the Honorable
12 Ramon "RB" B. Camacho, Mayor, Municipality of Saipan; Natalia M. Sablan,
13 Acting Secretary, Department of Finance; Virginia C. Villagomez, Special
14 Assistant, Office of Management and Budget; Joseph M. Pangelinan, Director,
15 Office of Personnel and Management; and the Honorable David M. Apatang,
16 Governor, Commonwealth of the Northern Mariana Islands.

Prefiled: 9/25/2024

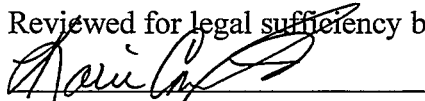
Date: _____

Introduced by: _____


Rep. John Paul P. Sablan

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION _____

Reviewed for legal sufficiency by:



House Legal Counsel

Date: 9-25-26